Apply — spot a disruption

Activity · Visualizations & Interpretation · ~25 min

BEFORE YOU START

☐ You have completed the previous 5 handouts

☐ You are signed in to the platform and inside your country project

☐ You are on the **Visualizations** tab

WHY IT MATTERS

The first five handouts taught the technique. This is where you use it: open a real disruption chart for your country, work the six-step framework on it, and produce a finding statement that a decision-maker would actually act on.

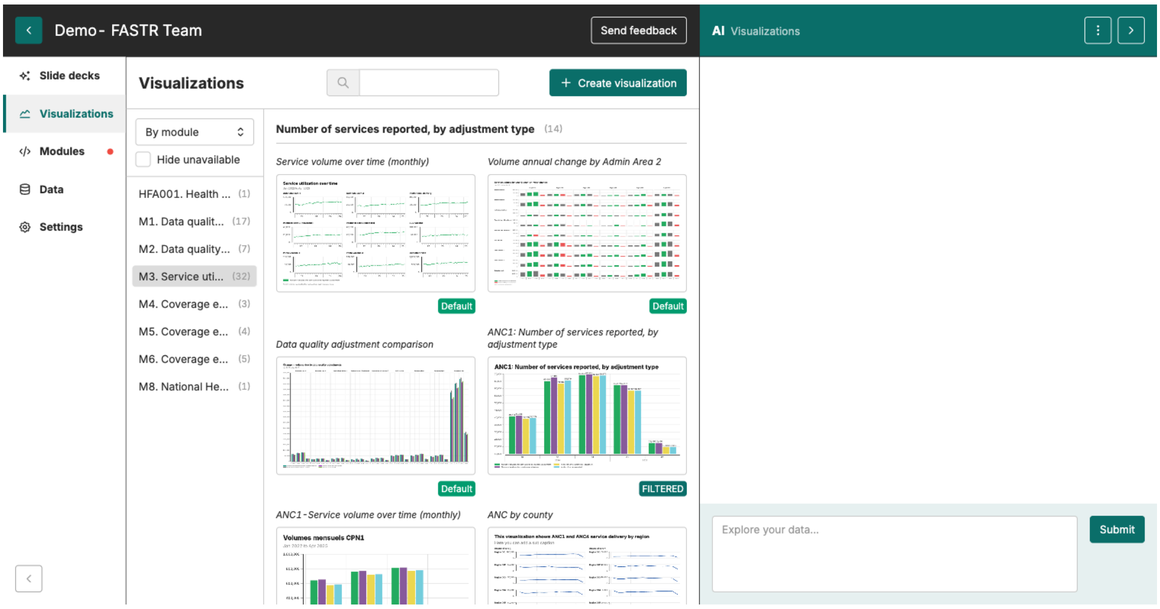
What you'll do

Open the Disruptions and surpluses (national) chart, narrow it to one indicator and a time window of interest, work through the six-step framework, then write a three-part finding to share with the room.

1 Find the disruption chart

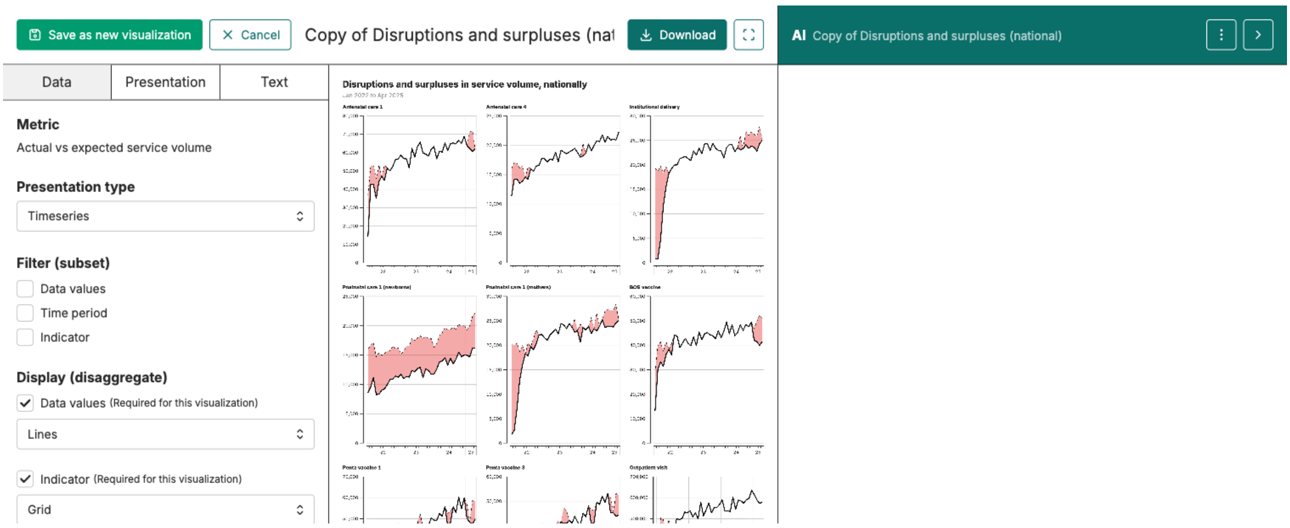
In the **Visualizations** tab, switch the view toggle (top left of the visualization list) to **By module**. This groups the visualizations by which module produced them.

Open **M3. Service utilization**. Scroll until you see the group titled **Actual vs expected service volume — National**. The first card in that group is **Disruptions and surpluses (national)**. Click it to open.



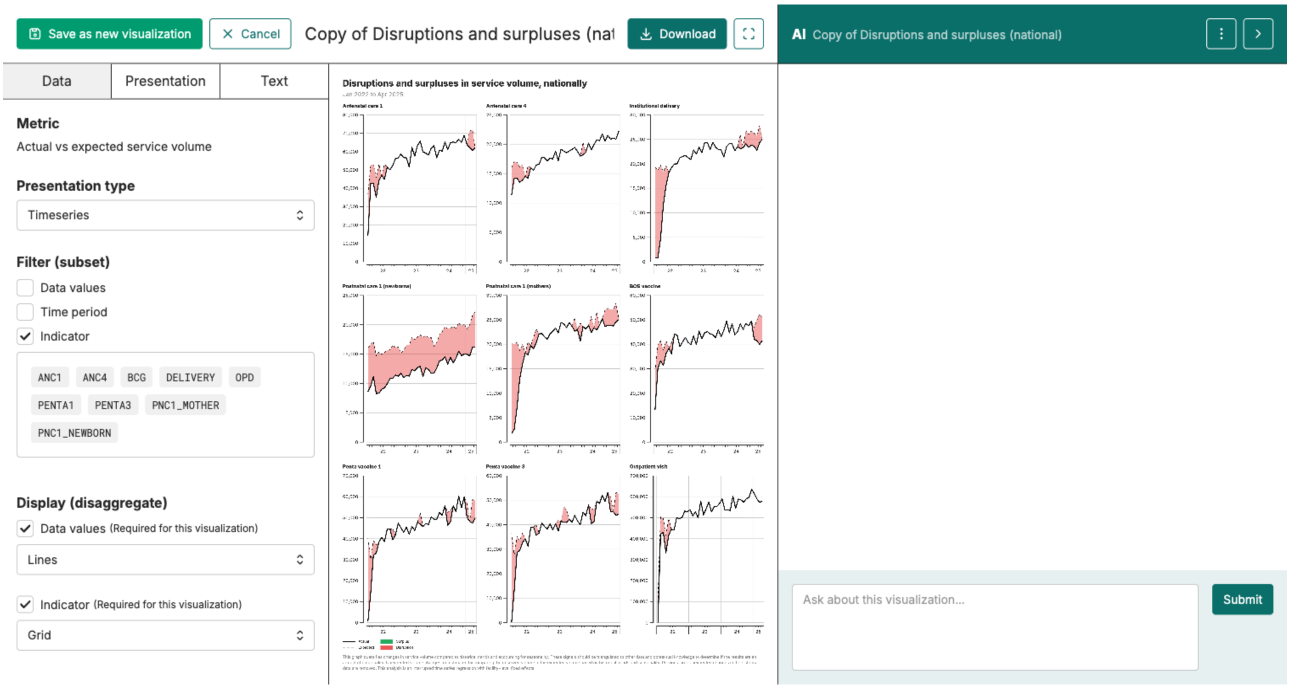
2 Read the default view

The default chart shows every core indicator as a small chart in a grid. Two black lines run across each chart: a **solid** line for **actual** monthly service volume, and a **dashed** line for the **expected** volume predicted from past trends. The area between them is filled — **red** where actual sits **below** expected (a disruption), **green** where actual sits **above** expected (a surplus).

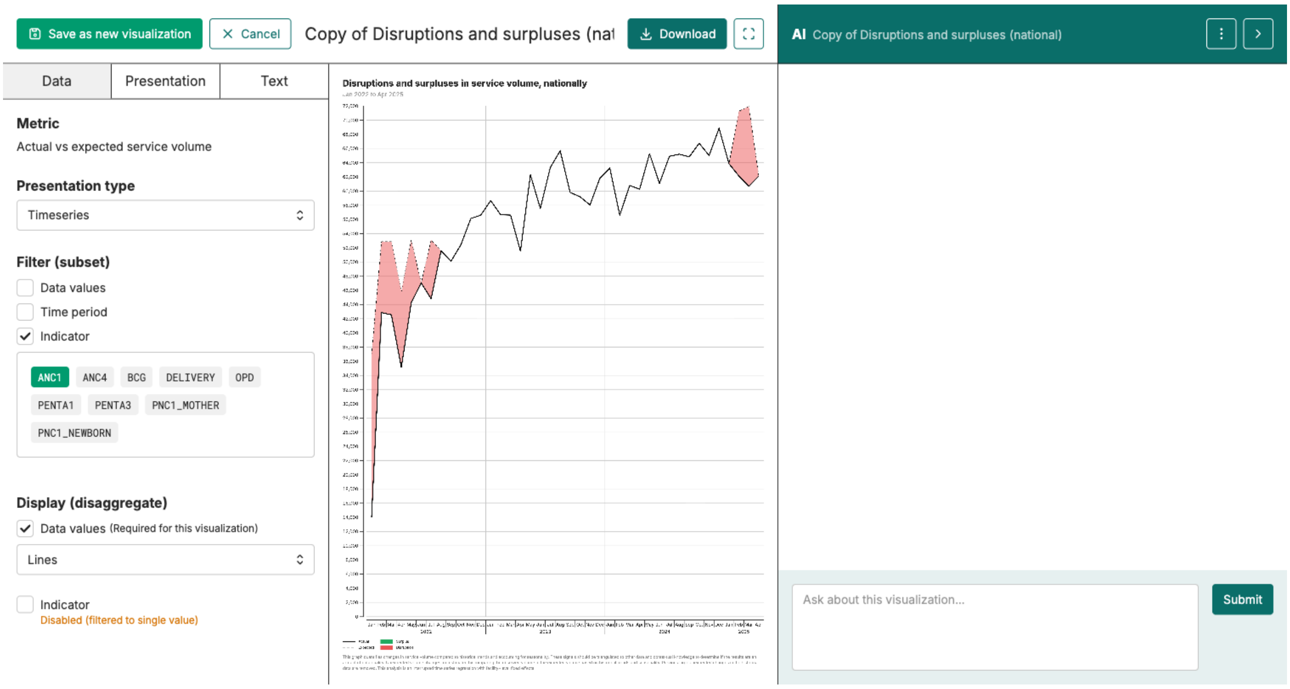


3 Filter to one indicator

In the **Data** tab on the left, find the **Filter (subset)** section and tick the **Indicator** checkbox. A list of indicator chips appears (ANC1, ANC4, BCG, DELIVERY, OPD, PENTA1, PENTA3, PNC1_MOTHER, PNC1_NEWBORN). Click one chip to filter the chart to that indicator. Click more chips to add others.



When a single indicator is selected, the grid collapses to a single full-size chart. You can also tick **Time period** to narrow the window further.



4 Work the six steps

On your filtered chart, walk the six-step framework from *Reading a viz*:

Step	For this chart
1. What indicator?	The one you filtered to
2. What level & period?	National. The period you chose.
3. What is being compared?	Actual monthly volume (solid black line) vs **expected** (dashed black line, predicted from past trends)
4. Read the values	Where does the gap fill red (actual below expected)? By how much?
5. What stands out?	A sustained drop, three months or more? A single spike? A pattern?
6. So what?	What action would this prompt?

5 Add context the chart cannot show

The chart shows the *what*. Your country team brings the *why*. Once you have a pattern, layer in what you know:

- Was there a **financing or staffing change** in that period?
- Are there known **supply or workforce gaps** (drugs, equipment, staffing)?
- Even if the **numbers look fine**, has the quality of care slipped?

6 Write your finding

Use the three-part structure from the *Write an interpretation* handout:

1. **Title** — the message in one sentence
2. **What you see** — facts visible in the chart
3. **What it means** — the so-what, tied to a concrete next step

7 Share with the room

When each country team is done, one person shares the finding. Listen for:

- Is the finding **specific**? One indicator, one period, one action.
- Is the so-what **tied to a real decision-maker**?
- Did the team **bring local context** the chart alone could not?

What to watch out for

- **A one-month dip is usually noise.** Look for a sustained drop, three months or more.
- **A green fill is not "good", a red fill is not "bad".** They just show direction: green = actual above expected, red = actual below expected. A small red fill for one month is normal noise; a sustained red over several months is what to investigate.

What's next

This is the end of the *Visualizations & Interpretation* series. The next module covers building reports — putting your charts, interpretations, and findings into a shareable document.